



Halt and Catch Fire

Taking you back to 1983, this new TV show gives a glimpse of life in the early IBM era. Take a look: <http://dgit.in/pcwrstvs>



Arkham Knight trailer

The next eagerly awaited installment in the Arkham series releases its first gameplay trailer. Check it out: <http://dgit.in/baktrlr>

Sssh...They're listening

Did the Indian government access Vodafone's network to intercept calls, text messages and emails? While the telecom department examines Vodafone's disclosure report, the issue of users' privacy has once again come into the limelight

Vodafone's latest Law Enforcement Disclosure report has triggered a new controversy as it reveals India to be among 29 countries that sought access to its network for intercepting calls, text messages and emails. Telecom Minister Ravi Shankar Prasad has directed the Department of Telecom to examine the report and assured an appropriate follow up thereafter.

Vodafone's report, however, doesn't reveal the precise number of requests or whether it complied to any request.

As per the Law Enforcement Disclosure report, "...in every country in which we operate, we have to abide by the laws of those countries which require us to disclose information about our customers to law enforcement agencies or other government authorities, or to block or restrict access to certain services. Those laws are designed to protect national security and public safety or to prevent or investigate crime and terrorism, and the agencies and authorities that invoke those laws insist that the information demanded from communications operators such as Vodafone is essential to their work."

"Refusal to comply with a country's laws is not an option. If we do not comply with a lawful demand for assistance, governments can remove our licence to operate, preventing us from providing services to



The Govt. of India may have accessed your private data

our customers. Our employees who live and work in the country concerned may also be at risk of criminal sanctions, including imprisonment. We therefore have to balance our responsibility to respect our customers' right to privacy against our legal obligation to respond to the authorities' lawful demands as well as our duty of care to our employees, recognising throughout our broader responsibilities as a corporate citizen to protect the public and prevent harm."

This latest disclosure about the government's attempts at spying on its citizens has triggered a nationwide debate over issues related to users' privacy. It's notable that all the major Internet companies including Google, Twitter, Facebook and Yahoo periodically release transparency reports, featuring figures on requests

made by the governments of all the countries.

The disclosure report also outlines the Indian laws on interception of calls and text messages. India's Section 69 of the IT Act permits "authorised government officials to intercept or monitor information transmitted, generated, received or stored in any computer. Accordingly, the service provider is required to extend all technical facilities, equipment and technical assistance to the authorised government officials to intercept the information and to provide information stored in the computer. The Interception Rules lay down the procedure to be followed by the government to authorise such interception or monitoring".

Malicious World Cup-themed apps targeting Android users

The 2014 FIFA World Cup in Brazil kicked off on May 12th, and Trend Micro researchers have pointed out yet another trend that fans need to be careful about: fake and malicious versions of World Cup-themed apps.

One of the malware families detected is ANDROIDOS_OPFAKE.CTD. According to Trend Micro, this particular family first appeared in May 2013, impersonating popular apps. Its malicious routines included subscribing the user to premium services, leaking user-critical information (such as contact list/messages) as well as installing malicious links and shortcuts on the mobile device's home screen. In just one year, the number of detected ANDROIDOS_OPFAKE.CTD variants reached 100,000, fake 14,707 apps.

Another malware family detected that was leveraging the World Cup fever was the

ANDROIDOS_SMSSTEALER.HBT family. Variants of this family shared similar methods of fraud and fakery with OPFAKE, with one exception: the former can connect to its remote C&C server to receive and



Malicious World Cup slot game app